

Direct Booking Website

Studio Apartment Newport, Wales, UK

A complete, international-standard direct booking platform for your short-stay studio apartment: live availability synced with Airbnb, Booking.com and Vrbo; secure online payments; a £200 damage deposit held by card; mandatory guest ID verification with your manual approval; an AI guest assistant; fully automated emails; and search-engine optimisation built in from day one.

Feasibility verdict: YES every feature you asked for is achievable. All requirements can be delivered with proven, mainstream technology (Next.js, Stripe, Stripe Identity, your existing Sympl channel manager via iCal sync, and the Claude AI API). One requirement the damage deposit needs a small, industry-standard adjustment in *how* it is implemented (explained in Section 3), but the end result you described is fully delivered, including the 10-day window after checkout.

1. Is it all possible? requirement-by-requirement

The table below lists every requirement from your brief and confirms how it will be delivered.

Your requirement	Possible?	How it will be delivered
Direct bookings (search availability, see price, book on your own website)	YES	Custom booking engine on your own domain: date search, live quote, guest details, payment all on your site.
Calendar fully synced with Airbnb, Booking.com and Vrbo double bookings impossible	YES	Two-way iCal sync with your existing Sympl channel manager (no API key needed just two links copied). The site imports Sympl's calendar every few minutes and exports its own feed so direct bookings block all OTA channels via Sympl. A final availability check inside the booking transaction plus your manual-approval step act as further safety guards.
Secure card payments	YES	Stripe. Card details go directly to Stripe (never touch your server) PCI-compliant, 3-D Secure, Apple/Google Pay ready.
£200 damage deposit held (not charged), chargeable up to 10 days after checkout, auto-released if no damage	YES	Delivered via the industry-standard pattern: card securely saved at booking, £200 hold placed on check-in day, one-click release or charge from your dashboard, off-session charge capability covering the full 10-day window. See Section 3.
AI chat assistant for guest questions and check-in/out queries	YES	Claude AI-powered chat widget on every page, grounded in a knowledge base of your property, house rules, location and FAQs. It answers 24/7 and never invents prices or availability.
Full SEO for Google (speed, mobile, structured data, local SEO)	YES	Next.js static rendering (very fast), mobile-first design, JSON-LD VacationRental structured data, sitemap, meta/OpenGraph tags, and local-SEO copy targeting Newport short stay , estudio apartment Newport etc.
Mandatory ID upload (passport / driving licence / national ID) before confirmation	YES	Built into the booking flow the booking cannot proceed to payment until the ID step is completed.

Your requirement	Possible?	How it will be delivered
Automatic ID scanning and data extraction, sent to you securely	YES	Stripe Identity: automatic document scan, authenticity checks, extraction of name, date of birth, document number and expiry. Results appear in your private dashboard and are emailed to you.
Manual approval – only guests you approve can stay	YES	Every booking is held as ‘pending approval’. You review the ID details and click Approve or Reject. The guest’s payment is only captured on approval; rejection releases it automatically.
Automated confirmation, check-in and check-out emails	YES	Automatic emails: confirmation on approval, check-in instructions the day before arrival, check-out instructions on departure morning.
Modern, professional, mobile-first design	YES	Clean international design, fully responsive for mobile, tablet and desktop.
GDPR-compliant handling of payments and ID documents	YES	ID document images stay inside Stripe Identity (never stored on your server); card data handled entirely by Stripe; minimal guest data kept and auto-purged after a retention period; privacy policy and terms pages included.

2. Recommended architecture and technology

A fully custom web application, built with modern, widely-used technology, connected to best-in-class services. This is the only approach that delivers your exact deposit, ID-verification and manual-approval rules — off-the-shelf booking widgets cannot do this.

Website & booking engine	Next.js 15 + TypeScript + Tailwind CSS — fast, SEO-strong, mobile-first
Payments & deposit	Stripe (payments, saved cards, holds, off-session charges)
ID verification	Stripe Identity — automatic document scan and data extraction (~£1.20 per check)
Channel sync	Sympl (your existing channel manager) via two-way iCal — no API key required; adapter design allows API-based sync later
AI guest assistant	Claude API chat widget with property knowledge base
Automated emails	Resend — confirmation, check-in, check-out, host alerts
Database	Prisma — SQLite for development, Postgres for production
Hosting	Vercel — global CDN, scheduled jobs for automations, HTTPS included

Demo (mock) mode: the entire website will run end-to-end on your computer with simulated payments, ID checks and calendar sync — before you sign up or pay for any service. When each real connection is ready (Stripe keys, Sympl iCal links, etc.), it is added to the settings and the real integration switches on.

3. The £200 damage deposit — how your exact outcome is achieved

One technical fact to know: Stripe (like all card processors) automatically expires a card pre-authorisation after about 7 days. So a hold placed on the day of booking cannot still be captured — within 10 days after checkout — if the guest booked more than a week in advance. The solution below is the standard used across the hospitality industry and delivers everything you asked for:

At booking	The guest’s card is securely saved and verified (£0 — nothing charged). The guest clearly sees: “£200 damage deposit” held, not charged.
Check-in day	A £200 hold is placed on the saved card automatically. Funds are reserved on the guest’s card but never enter your account.
After checkout	You inspect the property. In your dashboard: one click to Release the deposit, or Charge up to £200 with a note if there is damage.
No action taken	The hold is released automatically — the guest is never charged.
Days 7–10 after checkout	Even after the hold expires, the saved card still allows a charge of up to £200 — covering your full 10-day inspection window.

4. The guest booking journey

- 1. **Search availability** — calendar shows only genuinely free dates (your bookings + Airbnb/Booking.com/Vrbo blocks). Maximum 2 guests enforced.
- 2. **See the price** — transparent breakdown: nightly rate — nights + cleaning fee.
- 3. **Guest details** — name, email, phone, country.

4. **ID verification** – passport, driving licence or national ID scanned automatically; details extracted and sent to your dashboard.
5. **Payment** – stay total authorised on the card (not yet charged) and card saved for the deposit.
6. **Pending approval** – dates are blocked on the website immediately and sent to Sympl, which blocks all OTA channels; you receive the ID details by email and in the dashboard.
7. **You approve** – payment is captured and the confirmation email goes out. **You reject** – the authorisation is released (guest never charged) and dates reopen.
8. **Automated stay emails** – check-in instructions the day before arrival; check-out instructions on departure morning; £200 hold placed on check-in day.

5. Property page – content included

A beautiful, professional property page presenting the studio to international guests:

Sleeping & living (max 2 guests)

• 2 comfortable single beds, sofa, 2 chairs, table for dining and working

Appliances & amenities

• Fridge freezer • 50-inch smart TV • wardrobe • iron & ironing board • hair dryer

Kitchen area (no cooking)

• Kettle, toaster, microwave oven • complimentary tea, coffee and sugar

Laundry & bathroom

• Washing machine & tumble dryer • private bathroom with bathtub and shower • central heating

Connectivity & parking

• Free Wi-Fi • free street parking (legal parking is the guest's responsibility)

Location highlights

• Newport, Wales, UK – approx. 1 mile from the city centre

• Around 5 minutes from Newport train station

• About 2 miles from Celtic Manor Resort

• Around 10 miles from Cardiff

• Approx. 50 minutes from Bristol Airport

6. Your private dashboard

• All bookings with status filters (pending, approved, checked-in, completed)

• Guest ID verification results with extracted details (name, DOB, document number, expiry)

• One-click Approve / Reject for each booking

• Deposit controls: Release or Charge up to £200 with a note

• Calendar view combining direct bookings and Airbnb/Booking.com/Vrbo blocks

• Resend any guest email

7. Estimated running costs

Service	Typical cost
Hosting (Vercel)	£0/month for one property (free tier)
Domain name	~£10/year
Channel manager (Sympl)	Already in place – £0 extra for the website (iCal sync is free)
Stripe payments	~1.5%–2.9% + 20p per transaction (no monthly fee)
Stripe Identity	~£1.20 per guest verification
Email (Resend)	£0/month at your volume

AI chat (Claude API)	Pennies per conversation - typically < £5/month
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8. Build plan

Phase 1	Foundation: project setup, design system, property page, SEO structure
Phase 2	Booking engine: availability search, pricing, booking wizard (demo mode)
Phase 3	Payments & deposit: Stripe integration, ID verification step
Phase 4	Dashboard & approval workflow
Phase 5	Automated emails and scheduled jobs; two-way iCal sync with Sympl
Phase 6	AI chat assistant; final polish, mobile QA, SEO validation

9. What you will need to provide (later - the site works in demo mode without them)

- ☐ Stripe account (with Identity enabled) - free to create
- ☐ Sympl: copy two iCal links (Simpl's export link into the website; the website's feed link into Sympl) - free, ~5 minutes
- ☐ Resend account with your sending domain verified
- ☐ Anthropic (Claude) API key for the chat assistant
- ☐ Domain name and a free Vercel account for hosting
- ☐ Property photos and your preferred house rules text

Conclusion: everything requested in your brief is technically possible and will be delivered as described above. Yes - we can build this website.

Prepared 4 July 2026 - Newport Studio Direct Booking Website - Project Proposal